MLA 9th Edition Academic Research Paper Format

Student Last Name 1 | Student Name | Professor Name | Course Name | Day Month Year

HEADER & IDENTIFICATION BLOCK

MLA style does not mandate a separate title page unless requested. The top-left corner on page 1 lists: Student Full Name, Instructor Name, Course Title and Section, and Date. Running head in top-right corner displays [Last Name Page#] on every page.

PAPER TITLE

Centered in standard font (no bold, no italics, no underline) directly below the header block. Text follows with standard 0.5-inch paragraph indentation.

INTRODUCTION & THESIS STATEMENT

Establish cultural or textual context. The final sentence of the introductory paragraph should articulate an explicit, arguable thesis statement governing the analytical trajectory of the paper.

BODY PARAGRAPHS & TEXTUAL ANALYSIS

Each paragraph begins with a clear topic sentence, followed by textual evidence, direct quotation or paraphrase, and extensive analytical commentary. Use parenthetical citations (Author Page).

BLOCK QUOTATIONS

Quotations exceeding 4 lines of prose or 3 lines of poetry are formatted in a free-standing block indented 0.5 inches from the left margin, with no enclosing quotation marks.

CONCLUSION

Recontextualize the thesis in light of the developed arguments. Emphasize why the textual, historical, or literary reading matters to the scholarly discourse.

WORKS CITED

- Eliot, T. S. The Waste Land and Other Poems. Edited by Frank Kermode, Penguin Books, 2021.
- Modern Language Association. MLA Handbook. 9th ed., Modern Language Association of America, 2021.
- Spivak, Gayatri Chakravorty. "Can the Subaltern Speak?" Postcolonial Studies Reader, edited by Bill Ashcroft, Routledge, 2020, pp. 24-28.